

Riverbend Health Plan: Utilization Management Delegation Agreement

Clinical and Operational Addendum (Document ID RIVERBEND-ADDENDUM) | Amended and restated effective January 1, 2026

1. Scope of delegation

Riverbend Health Plan ('Riverbend') delegates prior authorization for medical services to Bellcourt Health Administrators ('Bellcourt') for two insured products: (a) Riverbend Medicare Advantage HMO, serving members in Arizona and Texas; and (b) Riverbend Marketplace Silver HMO, an ACA individual-market plan serving members in Georgia. Pharmacy prior authorization is not delegated. Riverbend retains ultimate accountability to CMS and state regulators and oversees Bellcourt through quarterly delegation audits.

2. Clinical criteria

Bellcourt shall apply the Bellcourt medical policy library in effect on the date of service, except as set out below.

2.1 Medicare Advantage: Medicare coverage rules take precedence

For Medicare Advantage members, where a Medicare National Coverage Determination (NCD) or applicable Local Coverage Determination (LCD) exists, its criteria must be applied and Bellcourt criteria may not be more restrictive. For the following services, Riverbend has confirmed the Medicare criteria to apply:

Service	Criteria to apply for MA members (simplified training summary)
Continuous glucose monitors	Diabetes mellitus AND either (a) insulin treatment of any type or frequency, or (b) documented problematic hypoglycemia. Applies to all dates of service under this Agreement.
CPAP continued coverage	As MP-118 (4 or more hours per night on at least 70% of nights in a consecutive 30-day period within the first 90 days).
Hyperbaric oxygen therapy	As MP-112.
Home health services	As MP-116.

2.2 Marketplace product

Bellcourt medical policies apply without modification.

3. Decision timeframes

Product	Standard pre-service	Expedited / urgent	Basis
Medicare Advantage	7 calendar days	72 hours	CMS Interoperability and Prior Authorization Final Rule (CMS-0057-F), effective January 2026
Marketplace (GA)	15 calendar days	72 hours	State law and Agreement

Clocks start when Bellcourt receives the request through any channel, including fax, regardless of whether it has been entered into Bellcourt's systems.

4. Adverse determinations

- Only a licensed physician may issue a denial based on medical necessity. Nurses may approve but may not deny.
- For Arizona members, effective July 1, 2026, a medical director licensed in Arizona must personally review and sign every denial of a medical-necessity request.
- Every denial notice must state the specific reason, cite the criteria relied on, and describe appeal rights.
- For Texas members, where any automated or AI-assisted tool was used in reviewing the request, the notice must disclose that use.

5. Automation and artificial intelligence

Bellcourt shall give Riverbend 60 days' written notice before deploying any automated or AI-assisted tool in the prior authorization workflow. No such tool may deny, delay, or modify a request on its own; a qualified human must make every adverse decision. Bellcourt must be able to produce, on audit, the inputs and outputs of any such tool for a given case.

6. Performance standards and remedies

Measure	Standard	Remedy if missed
Timeliness (each product, each quarter)	At least 97% of decisions within timeframe	Service credit of 4% of quarterly delegation fees per percentage point below standard; two consecutive misses require a Corrective Action Plan
Decision accuracy (Riverbend audit sample)	At least 95%	Corrective Action Plan
Appeal overturn rate (MA)	Monitored; above 30% triggers root-cause review	Root-cause review

7. Term and renewal

The current term ends December 31, 2026. Either party may elect not to renew with 90 days' notice. Riverbend may terminate for cause if a Corrective Action Plan is not satisfied within 120 days.

8. Interoperability

Bellcourt shall support Riverbend's obligations under CMS-0057-F, including an electronic prior authorization API, provider access to prior authorization status, and public metrics reporting, by the dates set in that rule (January 2027 for API requirements).